



LEARNING

300% FASTER

25 Learning Techniques

SEBASTIAN ARCHER

Learning
300% Faster

**25 Learning Techniques of Accelerated
Learning Masters**

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Introduction: Why You Can Learn 300% Faster... Starting Today!

"Live as if you were to die tomorrow. Learn as if you were to live forever." –
Mahatma Gandhi

"Your brain is like a sleeping giant. Learn how to learn – it's the most important skill." – Tony Buzan

You are a beautiful learning machine.

However you feel about learning new skills and subjects at this moment, know that your brain and body has evolved over millions of years to be the greatest skill and knowledge acquisition tool on the planet. It's the simple truth.

But like with any supercomputer, without a manual we have no idea how to use it properly to its highest potential. It's the same with the human mind and body. For most of human history, we have not made optimal use of our capacity to learn. We simply haven't known how.

Also, unfortunately the way things are taught at school often creates negative feelings in many of us related to learning new things. While also imprinting strange and ineffective strategies for learning in our brains. The education system is usually based on outdated methodology which was developed over 100 years ago, when people had even less understanding of how the human mind works and learns.

Worst of all, at school we often develop beliefs that we can't learn certain things, and other such nonsense. If you have lived with beliefs like these, it's time to drop them and accept the liberating truth. You can learn anything you like, and much *much* faster than you think.

The dawn of a learning revolution

Today, we live in very exciting times. The sciences of learning have skyrocketed our understanding of how to use our own minds, and how to learn with

incredible speed. Many different fields are contributing to this area of knowledge, combining and making great leaps forward every year, even every month.

This book collects together and delivers 25 of the most powerful learning concepts and techniques in a simple, easy to follow format. Any one of these techniques has the capacity to have you learning dramatically faster. When used together, in combination, these techniques will easily increase your learning speed by 300% and more. Perhaps much more.

Collected here are the simplified lessons of chess masters like Josh Waitzkin, world memory champions like Dominic O'Brien, speed-learning gurus like Tim Ferriss and Joel Canfield, and Neuro Linguistic Programming masters like Tony Robbins and Richard Bandler, plus plenty of other techniques used by the world's top performers and fastest learners.

All delivered in a simplified and clarified step-by-step way that will allow you to mimic their success, starting right away.

How to use this book

The ideal way to process these lessons is to skim through the book once quickly. Get an overall feel for the content. Then read through it a second time slowly. Write down notes on how you might make practical application of any of the techniques.

Then pick out one or two techniques or mindsets that seem most compelling, exciting and realistic to you. Immediately – that means today – turn to a skill or subject you are learning and begin to make practical application of that technique. Nothing beats instant action.

Over time return to the book and begin to experiment and apply more and more of these techniques. Play around with them, have fun with it. Remember, you were born to learn. Learning should be fun!

In the first section, you will learn the 8 overall foundational strategies and mindsets of the world's fastest learners. Including how to build deep, lasting excitement and motivation for learning, how to create the ideal learning environment, and how to love the process of learning once more, even in moments of failure and frustration. How to power on through and smash your learning goals.

In the next section, you will discover the 10 most advanced techniques on the planet for rapid skill acquisition. Including how the world's fastest learners reach world-class standards in 6 months, how to break down any subject or skill to identify its most essential components, and how to use this to seemingly perform miracles in your speed of progression. Here you will also learn how you can use NLP modelling to quickly understand a specific skill and replicate it as well as a pro.

In the third section, you will learn 9 powerful and practical memory techniques used by world memory champions. Including how your brain stores any fact permanently, with easy recall. How to learn vast quantities of academic facts permanently and rapidly, how to remember names, 'to do' lists, and numbers easily, and how to learn speeches and presentations to deliver without notes. And as a final treat, how to build memory palaces for truly epic heights of knowledge storage.

My friend, I am excited for you. I hope you are too!

In the very first chapter, we'll talk about how to embrace the mindset of Michael Jordan to begin learning seriously fast.

Section One: Mindset & Overall Learning Strategy

Chapter One: Develop a Nurturing Mindset for Incremental Progress

“My greatest skill was being teachable.” – Michael Jordan

“It’s not that I’m smart. It’s just that I stay with problems longer.” – Albert Einstein

Even before you take your first step in learning anything, you must make sure that you have the correct understanding of what you are as a learning entity. You must develop and nurture a healthy, flexible, liberated mindset.

People generally view themselves as one of two things. Either as complete already, with smartness that is ingrained, already determined, a part of who you are. Or they see themselves as a constantly evolving person, who has no fixed level of smartness. Your intelligence just grows or fades depending on what actions and work you do. This is the more accurate viewpoint.

Chess prodigy, martial arts champion and speed-learning specialist Josh Waitklyn defines these two ways of thinking as ‘Entity’ versus ‘Incremental’ theorists. To become a masterful lifelong learner, you must become an ‘Incremental’ theorist.

So that when you succeed or fail, you know the truth. That it was because of how little or how much you worked. Also, it is because of how effective your strategy or learning technique was. You know the truth that with hard work and intelligent learning you can grasp materials and progress in any skill, step by step, day by day, until you eventually master it.

Most people do not think like this. They are ‘Entity’ theorists.

They believe that if they fail or succeed, it is because of who they are, not because of something they can change. These people do not survive challenges and obstacles, which are a natural part of the learning process. When they are challenged they are brittle, like fragile glass. They get personally upset and they quit. They want everything to remain the same. Static. Unmoving. And they

believe life is this way.

“ The key to pursuing excellence is to embrace an organic long-term learning process, and not live in a shell of static safe mediocrity.” – Waitkin

Therefore, your very first step to learning new subjects and skills quickly is to separate your identity from the skills you learn. Accept that as you learn you will go right outside your comfort zone. You will become vulnerable. Accept this and commit to continuing beyond that point. Beyond the points of resistance you will encounter.

I mean it. Please think about yourself right now. Think about times you have learned things in the past. How did you view things and feel when you started feeling uncomfortable? Or when you hit an obstacle or failed? Did you crumble and quit, or did you embrace it?

Make a commitment to right now to become a pure incremental theorist. A flexible, learning machine (which you already are, just accept it). Start looking forward to the moments of discomfort and obstacles that are inevitably coming your way as you learn new skills. Like Jordan and Waitkin, prepare to smile and embrace these uncomfortable moments.

For this, you need to develop humility. To know that you do not know. There are many things that you cannot do, and you will have to face that on this journey of learning.

Michael Jordan, the greatest basketball player of all time, lived and breathed this mentality. Even at the height of his skill when he was better than anyone else, he would always listen to his teachers, and to other players. He would take on board their ideas and try them out, even if he disagreed with them. Because he knew he might be wrong. He had great humility that way.

To be a truly fast and powerful learner, you must develop this way of being too. This incremental way of thinking is not always easy to take on. But you can do it. Come back to this chapter and the following ones whenever you feel a little resistance, just to remind yourself that it's good. Discomfort and resistance means you're on the right track.

Every skill takes time. Even when you're learning it five or ten times faster than everyone else, as you will be after this book.

When you begin a new skill you need to accept that it will take time, and enjoy

the incremental moments of progressing step by step for as long as it takes. The next chapter will help you with developing this patience, and more specifically, it will show you how to take mistakes and moments of failure and make them your friends.

Chapter Two: Learn to Handle Mistakes and Failure Like a Master

"Give me a fruitful error any time, full of seeds, bursting with its own corrections." – Vildredo Pareto

"There are only two mistakes one can make along the road to truth. Not going all the way and not starting." – Buddha

You must maintain a joyful presence as you learn. A relaxation of the conscious mind. Like a child who learns something they are enjoying. They are lost in the moment. They are not self-conscious. They are entirely focused on the job at hand. The new ideas, facts and revelations.

The biggest threat to this focused yet relaxed optimal state of learning is when you make mistakes. And so a very important skill to learn is how to deal with a mistake when you really have tried your best. The trick is to be able to regain a clear, calm, focused presence of mind as quickly as possible after you have made a mistake or failed.

See your normal joyful learning state as a ship or a yacht, cruising forward joyfully across the sea. Enjoying the feel of wind in its sail, loving the journey and excited about the destination. In these moments of calm waters and good weather you are easily enjoying the learning process.

But storms will come. Huge gusts of wind from nowhere, or giant crashing waves.

When the ship is struck – when you are struck by an obstacle or difficult point or a feeling of sudden self-doubt. In those moments the ship is tilting to the side, it has become unbalanced. The key here is to focus on regaining balance. Move yourself as swiftly as possible back to a clear, calm, focused presence of mind. Do not let it bother you that there was a storm, just accept it and move back to your centred learning self. Don't quit. Don't let a mere storm sink you. Always remember:

“Even in the midst of the storm the sun is still shining.” — Dayna Lovely

This returning to your balanced, calm self is usually the hardest after you have made the same mistake 3 or 4 times. This is the point where your mind will start to become frustrated, and start telling you to stop for the day, or quit altogether. It will start telling you that this skill is not for you. That there are other things you are more suited to learning, there are other things more fun to do with your time.

Has your mind ever tried to stop you learning like this?

This is the most serious moment of threat to your learning process. If you do not handle it well and return to your peaceful, focused, presence of mind – the ideal state for learning – then it could spiral on downwards. Stealing your motivation and destroying your will to continue.

Four steps to learning from a mistake, turning it into a valuable experience

“Mistakes are the portals of discovery.” – James Joyce

Everyone handles mistakes differently. Make sure you’re the person who smiles and uses it to progress faster. There are a few things you have to do to make the most out of the golden opportunity a mistake in learning offers.

1. Admit you’ve made the mistake

“Mistakes are always forgivable, if one has the courage to admit them.” – Bruce Lee

This is essential. You must admit you made the mistake, and that it was due to your actions that it happened. This is not always as easy as it sounds.

There is great danger in blaming someone or something else for what happened. The moment you do that you are distancing yourself from the possibility of learning a valuable lesson here. You are not progressing at all.

Wise people and world-class learners very quickly own up to their mistakes. They are eager to. Even if it was partly someone else’s responsibility they are eager to accept or try to find some way in which they were responsible.

In fact, they are hungry to accept full responsibility for the mistake. Because they see the value there, the chance to leap forward in this skill. The moment you take ownership for your mistake, just admitting it to yourself or to others,

you gain great understanding. You can learn the lesson. You can take a big step forward in the skill.

2. Ask yourself, what is the lesson here?

Consciously ask yourself what lesson you can take away from this experience. What are you doing wrong? What can you try to do next time to avoid this mistake and progress past it?

Analyse the sequence that led up to the moment. Run it through in your mind, and in practice.

Look at what others are doing differently to get past it. Ask your teacher or mentors what you might do. Seek out the lesson like a hunting wolf. Need to refresh your mind? Make the mistake again! Keep on asking until you are past it.

3. Be courageous in the changes you have to make

“Success is not final, failure is not fatal: it is the courage to continue that counts.” — Winston S. Churchill

Change can be hard. Especially if we have been learning a skill for a while, and we are settled into habitual ways of doing things. It’s often hardest to try to change something when the old way has been working well for you, up until this point.

The way past this sticking point might require some deep change on many levels of the new skill. It might seem a huge effort. It may well require for you to get worse for a while, as you do things the new way. That can be a painful process to go through.

It might also require a great deal of experimentation. You might not be sure of the exact way past this mistake, you only know you have to try different ways.

You need courage to make this change. You need determination to succeed and reach your end goal of mastery. Get past your own doubts, remember to have humility. A sense of self-deprecating humour will often help at this point. Laugh a little at the situation. Keep things fun and light if you can.

Above all, do not stop. If you can beat these moments, you step above and beyond all others. And you cannot fail.

4. Look back afterwards and see how valuable that mistake was

It's very important to train your mind to value and even get excited about mistakes. To see them as they truly are – opportunities to take great leaps forward in your learning.

Once you have pushed past a mistake and are progressing on to new levels of your skill, take a moment to look back at what happened. Notice how that mistake drew all your focus and attention to that area of the skill, and because of it you grew and progressed.

Ask yourself, if I had not made that mistake many times and then really analysed it, and then had the courage to try something different, would I be at the level of skill I am now? The answer is probably 'no'.

Taking a moment to look back and be grateful for that mistake, no matter how painful it was at the time. This will make sure the next time you hit a sticking point you will be filled with excitement and energy to overcome it.

The next chapter will teach you how to set a clear destination, and put wind in your sails.

Chapter Three: Set Measurable Goals

“Setting goals is the first step in turning the invisible into the visible.” – Tony Robbins

Whenever you learn something, always set yourself measurable goals to aim for. Goals that will test your skill or knowledge at some time in the near future with absolute clarity.

Always make these goals just challenging enough to be exciting. When you visualise yourself achieving them in the timeframe you have set, you smile because it's very exciting. Make sure your goals are not so challenging so that you feel they are impossible. And also not so easy that you feel bored by them.

As you begin putting the lessons in this book into practice you will realise that goals you previously thought impossible become very achievable. That's very exciting.

The reason to set goals is because the human brain works like a heat-seeking missile. When you set it a fixed target it will bring everything to focus to achieve it. Consciously and unconsciously.

A great deal of learning happens in the unconscious mind, beneath the surface. Even when you are not thinking about the skill, your unconscious mind is processing it, assimilating it, relating it and developing it. The more important your unconscious mind sees this skill, the better it will help you to progress. The clearer your destination with this skill, the more clearly your mind will be able to work towards it.

Make your goal as measurable as possible, so it's crystal clear to your mind what exactly has to be achieved. Vague goals are less effective. Remember the analogy comparing the human mind to a supercomputer? Well crystal-clear, measurable, exciting yet believable goals are the easiest way to get that entire supercomputer working in the direction you desire.

Your unconscious mind will see the clear goal, at a specific time in the future, and it will constantly be working backward from there, seeing all the steps back to the present moment, working out what exactly is needed to achieve the next

step. It will constantly be comparing that near destination to where you are now, and determining what you need to do next.

Any time you sit down and think about the skill you will see where you need to go, and where you are today. It will steer you correctly through the specific elements of the skill you need to focus on, and it will help you take lessons from mistakes and stop you from repeating them.

Setting a measurable goal will always greatly speed up the learning process. Always.

And don't just accept a goal set for you by someone else. Think of it for yourself. Only you know what you want, and where you want to go.

Before you set goals, it's important that you have worked on the mindsets discussed in chapters one and two. Short term goals are very useful tools to speed up learning, but only within a healthy, nurturing long term philosophy of learning.

Entity theory learners are terrified of goals, because if they fail to achieve them they feel like something is wrong with them – that they have found a permanent limitation. Become an incremental theory learner, and you will see goals just as they are, useful tools to help your mind focus on your long and happy road to mastery. Just that.

If you are scared or nervous about setting goals to learn to, it is likely that you are still mostly thinking as an entity theorist does. Go back to chapter one and reread it. Start to find ways to release yourself from this highly restrictive and inaccurate way of thinking.

Supercharge Your Learning Goal with Visualisation

Our brains are evolved to respond to clear visualisations of desired results. Visualisations work best when you have a clear, measurable goal to visualise. They also work better when you include elements of sound, touch, smell and taste.

When you visualise a desired result of your learning, your mind can latch on to something concrete and head towards it. Always start with the end result in mind. And make it clear to yourself what that will give you too. This will also give you a boost to your motivation through hard times.

From visualising, use back-stepping to determine exactly what you need to do

just before that end goal, and then the step just before that penultimate step, and all the way back to the present moment.

Determine exactly the skills you need so you know what to focus on, saving you time. For example, Tim Ferriss wanted to learn tango quickly. He set a goal to win or at least do well in the Buenos Aires tango championships. He visualised it a lot, and broke down what specifically was needed to win it. He realised a certain type of tango with wide, flowing steps often won. And he therefore focused only on this type of tango, saving him time.

If your end goal in learning a language is to speak it confidently when you visit that country. To make this more concrete perhaps you could aim to pass a certain speaking-only test in 3 or 6 months. Then, backtracking from there you realise you don't need to focus on reading and writing to achieve that specific goal. As you come all the way back to the present and first step, you see that you just need to find a way of learning that is entirely based around speaking and understanding. That is the most efficient route to your specific goal. And you will get there twice as fast.

Visualisation of your goals, even briefly, will help a great deal in making them real to you. And in highlighting the best and fastest route to reach them. Most learners never set clear goals, let alone visualise them. Make sure you don't make this mistake, it's a key learning trick. Your supercomputer mind responds to visual cues – help it to help you get there faster. Set your goals, and see them in your mind's eye.

You might use this technique for any skill. To study for an exam, visualise yourself calmly completing it to exceptional standards. You can then more easily work out exactly what you need to cover to achieve this. Then you might backtrack from that successful moment to this day, and see clearly the steps you have to take to get there. Perhaps starting with studying past exams in that subject, and then learning only the things that turn up in that particular exam, cutting what you need to focus on down significantly, and getting you there faster.

This technique of backtracking from a desired result will be explored in more detail in section two of this book. It's incredibly powerful.

Predict obstacles in advance

Those stormy moments we talked about. You know they are coming. To help

yourself power through them when they do, think about the obstacles that you will hit as you progress towards your goals.

The more you visualise your learning goals, the more you will start to see the journey accurately. It's likely that stumbling blocks will come up in your mind before you reach them. Make a plan, a few different ways you might deal with them once they arrive. And you will be much better prepared than most learners.

The next chapter will tell you one simple way to add rocket fuel to your goals.

Chapter Four: Add Stakes & Accountability to Your Learning Goals

"Creating incentives and assigning accountability are the two most important keys to achieving a goal." – Dean Karlan

To make your learning goal even more effective, set up some stakes so there are extra real life consequences to achieving or not achieving it. Obviously there are already very real consequences of achieving your learning goal in all the ways your life will be improved by having it.

But often those results are more mid-term to long-term. A few extra stakes can really help add some juice to your motivation and your learning curve. Make sure these extra stakes are something you care about, so you really would like to get it, or it really would be a pain if you didn't.

No matter how good your intentions are when you begin to learn a new skill, a few weeks or months down the line life will try to get in the way – a storm will hit. And this skill will for a time stop seeming so important.

With a few extra stakes you can greatly help your brain keep this skill at the top of your agenda and priorities, even in these difficult, distracting moments.

The stakes could be that you'll give your friend \$100 if you fail to do some learning task for one day. Or if you fail to hit your weekly learning goals. Anything that will matter to you and pack a bit of a blow. You can use a goal-staking service like Stickk.com to help with this.

Also, add accountability. When we tell someone else we're learning and aiming for something, it becomes more serious. We're naturally social creatures and when someone else is involved it makes the skill much more important to us. We all naturally want to follow through on our word. And we are naturally inclined to want to keep from telling other people that we've failed.

One thing, if you find an accountability partner, make sure they will be serious with you. They must be someone not afraid to have a hard word with you if you start to fail them.

The next chapter will tell you how to double up on this goal-enhancing power with properly-set rewards.

Chapter Five: Use Rewards and Celebration, Right from Go

“To set the right tone, and get on the right path, you must secure early wins.” –
Kate Matsudaira

Everyone needs early wins. This associates real pleasure in the brain connected with the skill or subject you’re learning. And real pleasure is the key to creating deep and lasting motivation in you to keep learning for the long term, even through those inevitable tough stormy patches.

Some skills and knowledge are perfectly designed to give you many early wins. For example, in tennis you will be winning games early and often. Chess will see you winning games too. If you are learning to speed read, you might measure your progress and see you are getting faster every week. If you’re learning a language you can start having little conversations right from the beginning and feel good about being able to have them. For a new subject at school, you can give yourself little tests of knowledge and celebrate the new things you know.

Make sure you recognise all wins, however small they are, and recognise how important they are for your learning process. Turn anything you can into a win. Consciously bring your attention to this little success, and congratulate yourself. It’s something many learners forget to do.

To further enhance the motivation-boosting effects, also take a moment to celebrate every little win. Really feel the pleasure and celebrate in any way you see fit. This has a very powerful effect on your brain and it will make you learn the skill faster, and with more pleasure. It will also reduce the negative impact of mistakes.

Celebrating could be a smile, a quick fist pump, hi 5-ing a friend or dancing down the street naked and singing. There is no right or wrong way, just do it. Celebrate.

Even further enhance this moralizing, motivating boost by giving yourself rewards. And set rewards for achieving your learning goals. Anything you find

remotely pleasurable can be set as a reward. Perhaps a massage at the end of the week. Or a nice meal out. A trip to the cinema. Some more time with your close friends. Or even during the day, give yourself mini-rewards with a coffee or some time reading your favourite book.

Rewards are personal, just write down a few ideas and start saying you can only have them once you get these little wins. It may seem small and trivial, but this is a deeply powerful concept that master-learners always use. They simply think this way – turning any pleasurable thing they want to do into a reward for getting a small win or hitting a small learning goal. To become a master-learner, start thinking this way too.

With early wins in mind, it's especially important to use this concept when you are jumping in at the deep end to learn a skill. This is where you are starting with extreme challenges right from the beginning. Many people like to learn this way.

If you do too, and you find you have challenged yourself too much, make sure that somehow you are mentally recognising little victories and celebrating them. This will keep you afloat and swimming, no matter how intense that initial learning period is.

For example, if you are learning tennis against a far better opponent, you might not be winning games, so instead celebrate every time you return the ball. Just make sure that mentally, the way you are seeing things, you are regularly making small victories and wins. Not continuously experiencing what you see as 'failures'.

Of course, the most powerful mindset is to take the lessons of chapter two to heart and see failures as wins too. Which they are. Because you have just been given the opportunity to learn a valuable lesson, which progresses you in the skill. If you can start thinking like this, you are becoming an unstoppable, dangerous learning machine.

In the next chapter you will learn perhaps the most important foundational learning strategy of all. Yet it's one that people often forget about or ignore. Make sure you give it the attention it deserves!

Chapter Six: Get the Best Models, Mentors & Teachers. Not Just Good. The Best

“The mediocre teacher tells. The good teacher explains. The superior teacher demonstrates. The great teacher inspires.” — William Arthur Ward

Learn from the very best, or as close as you can get. This can be in person, or through imitation, or through a course, or book. There is a theory that on average people achieve a level of 10% of that achieved by the mentors they follow and teachers they choose.

That is a random figure, but let's assume that you will achieve a certain proportion of the success of the person you choose to learn from. In that case, why not choose the mentor who has reached the highest level of skill? You will surely reach a higher point with the same amount of effort.

Always aim to learn from the very best, right from the get-go. This is one of the greatest techniques of the world's greatest learners.

It's also important to understand the difference between finding people to mentor you. People to teach you. And people to model. Many people who are highly skilled and fantastic to model, or perhaps to have as mentors, make terrible teachers.

This is because as people progress in a skill, they often unconsciously internalise many of the sub-skills and techniques as they continuously progress. So by the time someone has reached the very top of their game, they are consciously aware of completely different things than a beginner is. They have not thought about many basic skills in years, it is all so unconscious to them.

They then find it very difficult to see the skill through a beginner's eyes. And to guide you right from the start at the right speed, with the right sequence of components of the skill to focus on.

Also, teaching is itself an entirely separate skill. The art of helping someone else

to progress as fast as possible in a certain skill is very different to progressing in that skill yourself. To be a great teacher you have to master two separate things – the skill itself, and the skill of teaching.

Because of this the most successful people often do not make good teachers. And sometimes they do not make good mentors either. When you're choosing a teacher or a mentor, look not so much at them, but at what their other students are achieving. This will give you a good picture of whether they are right for you or not.

A good trick to finding teachers is when you look at the most skilled person at something, find out and observe the person or people who helped them get there. Find out what courses they studied or what mentor they had. It may well be better to have the coach of Tiger Woods teach you golf, rather than Tiger Woods himself.

You can also seek to model the best. This is learning from them when they are not necessarily aware of it. Studying them and carefully replicating what they do. A later technique in this book teaches you how to do modelling to a very high level. It's a powerful method taken from NLP.

Learning from the best also means finding the very best materials to study from. Never simply accept a textbook that someone puts into your hand. This is a mistake most people make with languages. Do your research, find out what successful experts used to study with, and use the same materials they used. This is equally as important as the quality of your teacher or mentor. Don't leave study materials to chance.

Well, you now have the most powerful foundational understandings and strategies for learning in the world. Remember them well. They will double and triple the speed-learning power of every other technique in this book.

Now for the really exciting stuff. Let's move onto the specific techniques used by the world's fastest learners. That's what the next two sections of the book are all about.

Section Two: Rapid Skill Acquisition Techniques

Chapter Seven: Destroy Distractions

“Distractions kill focused practice, and lack of focused practice leads to slow (or non-existent) skill acquisition.” – Josh Kaufman

Your actual level of skill and knowledge does not improve quickly during periods of just coasting along. Most people feel that when they sit down to learn something, or go into a class, and vaguely use the skill that it will improve. This is why most people take years to make progress in things they’re learning, instead of months.

This one simple understanding is one of the keys you can use to learn 5 or 10 times faster than everyone else.

When you decide to spend a period of time improving your skill or knowledge in something, make a commitment to learning rapidly and with great focus. Set aside a specific period during your days and weeks. And then most importantly create the right environment to learn in by eliminating distractions.

Eliminate even the possibility of distractions.

Distractions are the greatest cause for slow learning. Treat your learning time with great respect.

When you sit down to learn, it takes a period of time for your brain to mentally focus and slowly rise into the optimal learning state where you are completely immersed in the skill and learning at maximum speed. Every time you are distracted studies have shown it takes you an average of 25 minutes to fully return to that optimal state of learning.

Imagine your mind is like a snow globe. When you are moving around through your day the snow globe is shaking about, and the snow swirls around inside, filling the globe. Then when you sit down to begin learning, the snow is still filling the globe. Gradually it settles. It takes a while for all the snow to rest on the bottom, and then the water in the globe – in your mind – is clear and calm and fresh. You are in your optimal learning state, immersed in the skill or subject.

Every time there is even a small distraction it's like someone picked up that snow globe and shook it around. Instantly snow – random distracting thoughts and emotions – fills the globe. Then, when you turn back to the subject, it takes another 25 minutes again for all the snow to fully settle. For your mind to get back into that calm, focused optimal learning state.

Do not allow those distractions to happen.

Most distractions these days are from digital factors and human factors. Train other people to respect your learning time as much as you do. Explain to them that you cannot be disturbed or respond to their messages in this period. People will understand and respect you for it.

And turn off all digital things that could distract you. If something is left open even the anticipation of a potential distraction will hold back your mind from fully focusing and learning optimally. Turn it off. Nothing is so urgent it cannot wait an hour or two.

The world's greatest and fastest learners study this way. You must too.

In the next chapter you will learn an extremely important learning technique. One that almost everyone misses out. How to break down and deconstruct any skill or topic so that you know what you must learn first, so that you never feel overwhelmed, and you learn most efficiently. Boosting your motivation and cutting your learning curve in half with one blow.

Chapter Eight: Deconstruct to Destroy Overwhelm

"The journey of a thousand miles begins with one step." – Lao Tzu

Any skill can seem overwhelming to begin with. Just so many things to learn and internalize. So many bits of knowledge to memorise. To deal with this, most people simply can't think about the end result. They focus on only the beginning, which is good in some sense, but it means slow, random, unfocused progress.

Instead, you can deconstruct the skill.

This means breaking down what first appears complex into small, simple parts. Small enough where each part is easily manageable.

Ask yourself, 'what are the minimal learnable units of this skill?' The 'Lego blocks' as Tim Ferriss calls them. You can do this with four methods – by reducing, interviewing, reversal and translating.

Reversal is starting at the point of visualisation we previously talked about in the goals chapter. Look at the final product of your skill and backtrack all the way back to now to find the best way to begin the task. Each stage and step becomes smaller and more manageable, less intimidating. If any of the steps still seem too large, break them down even further. There is no limit to how small you can go. In fact, this is the next method to deconstructing – reducing.

Reducing is breaking down each component, each move, each part or step in a skill, and reducing it further still. Into very, very tiny little pieces. NLP modelling later on will teach you one way to do this masterfully.

Another fantastic way to deconstruct anything you are learning is to interview experts and ask them for the most common mistakes, and the main principles of the skill. Explain to them exactly what you are trying to achieve. And they will help you to break it down.

The fourth method is translating, which means finding ways your existing skills can help you to shortcut learning things in the new skill. For example with

languages, if you are learning Polish you can remember that all words in English ending in 'tion' are the same and end in 'cja' in Polish.

Many physical skills and knowledge-based skills share components too. Look for any similarities, and again you can ask the experts. If you are learning Muay Thai Boxing, and you are already good at football, perhaps you can find some similarity in the dynamics of swinging your leg and turning your hips with power to kick accurately and effectively. Ask your teacher and they will confirm if this is true or not. If it is you have leaped forward in learning Muay Thai, because your mind and body is already familiar with the kicking part of it. You have translated something across from one skill to the other.

Use first principle-based thinking

The entire learning strategy of deconstruction is very similar to 'first principle-based thinking' as Elon Musk describes it. This is where you make a conscious step to separate yourself from the general view of what is necessary to achieve something. Common knowledge is rarely the most efficient and effective way to get from A to B.

But we usually just look at what everyone is doing and think that's the best way to do it. It's human nature. But it's not the way world-class learners do things. I hope you have gathered by now that to learn quickly you must ignore the way most people learn. Escape by reasoning from first principles.

"It's important to reason from first principles, rather than by analogy. The normal way we conduct our lives is we reason by analogy. We look at what others are doing, at how others have done it.

First principles means you boil things down to their most fundamental truths. And say 'what are we sure is true?' And then reason up from there." – Elon Musk

In Elon's case, the general knowledge was that rockets were extremely expensive to buy or build. He gathered a team and worked out all the exact component parts an actual rockets needs, which was a tiny fraction of the generally accepted price. Then he gathered those components together and build the rocket himself. He ignored the general common understanding of how things should be done.

How can you use this to learn faster? Let's look at learning a language as an example. Most people think to learn Spanish you should go to a Spanish class

and begin with basic grammar and lists of vocabulary. That's the commonly accepted way of doing things.

But if instead you start with the end result – you speaking Spanish confidently and fluently. Then you boil it down to its first principle components, you deconstruct it, you will see that the basic components are a familiarity with certain spoken sentence structures and a knowledge of only the most commonly used vocabulary, and a confidence through quick experience and many early wins using the language to effectively communicate.

Therefore, the minimal necessary components of learning Spanish may instead be to get yourself surrounded by Spanish, so go to Mexico or Spain. Don't start with grammar or reading or writing, simply speak functional sentences to people. So that in communicating early on you get many wins and your confidence and motivation increases.

Then focus your learning on the 1,000 most common words, using the memory techniques in this book, and expand from there. Plus perhaps set a goal, like a verbal test in three months, and put yourself in situations where you are forced to use Spanish daily, like some sort of physical martial arts or dance or cooking class in Spanish in Spain.

Here, we have broken the goal of speaking Spanish down to its first principles, its basic component parts and worked backwards from there. The result is that you only have to learn 10% of what the average Spanish-learner is trying to learn going to classes. And you are getting straight to the point, following the world's most intelligent learning techniques so you will reach the goal in 5% of the time it takes an average Spanish-learner.

This is the method many world-class learners have used to acquire languages in months instead of years. If a language is one of the skills you are planning to learn using this book, then there are many more techniques to come which will get you to fluency at incredible speeds.

To help you further focus on what matters in your learning journey, the next chapter gives another essential technique to boosting your learning efficiency.

Chapter Nine: Focus on the 20% that Gives You 80% of the Results

“Focus on being productive instead of busy.” – Tim Ferriss

Of all the things you do to move forward in a skill, some of those things will always move you forward faster. Some areas of the skill you’re learning are more important to focus on. They simply give you better results. It’s essential that you find out what these key areas are early on.

For every skill these key areas of maximum impact may be the same for everyone, or they may vary based on the individual learner.

Pay attention as you progress, and you will start to notice these 20% of your actions that give you 80% of your desired results. Then adjust how you are learning, to spend more time on those 20% actions, and you will progress faster. It’s that simple.

You can also speak to people ahead of you. Your teachers and mentors. Ask them to help you identify these 20% actions. Try out what they suggest, even if it sounds strange to you.

Often the areas of a skill that you focus on more may simply be because you enjoy those parts of the skill more. Here you have to make a decision, do you want the pleasure of doing that thing more, or the pleasure of learning this new skill more rapidly? Fortunately, most often as soon as you begin progressing faster, the new area of focus will become more pleasurable for you.

A big part of getting this technique right is experimenting. Be like Jordan. Don’t be afraid to try new things and new methods, no matter how much you like the way you were already learning. Try everything you hear about. It’s a process of discovery. And often, once you take the new approach and see how quickly you are progressing with it, you will start to enjoy it greatly too.

Also, use this 20% to 80% principle to work out which of the fundamental building blocks (from deconstructing the skill) are the most important to learn faster – so you can take the biggest strides to begin with. What this means is,

when you have deconstructed the skill into smaller blocks, some of those blocks will get you to your learning goals faster. Know which ones they are, and give them more focus. Spend more time on them.

It's not just the components of a skill that matter to accelerate your learning, it's also how you learn. The next chapter gives you a powerful understanding of how you can discover your own personal fastest learning system.

Chapter Ten: Find Your Preferred Learning Style

"Tell me and I forget. Teach me and I remember. Involve me and I learn." – Benjamin Franklin

We all learn in exactly the same ways. And we all learn slightly differently. As a speed learning master in the making it's important that you discover your own ultimate learning styles.

Every individual is naturally more inclined to learn better under certain conditions and following certain methods, and even through different senses.

This last point is important to understand. People are usually one or a combination of these following four types of learners depending on the senses the favor – visual, auditory, kinaesthetic or digital auditory.

This is a very advanced understanding of how the human mind learns, originally developed in NLP. But it is now widely recognised as highly accurate and important, even spreading into many education systems. Don't neglect it, it may dramatically speed things up for you.

This is also very closely connected to the concept of finding out your 20% that gives you 80% of learning results. If you find out that you learn twice as fast through auditory means, then you should focus on learning through those methods, perhaps from audiobooks and teachers who speak to you, more than books or visual means. You will progress twice as fast in the same time period.

To understand which type you are, consider these descriptions;

Visual people

Love to learn through their eyes. Prefer reading books to listening to lecturers. Remember expressions or things they have read in books more easily than what they have heard someone say. More easily distracted by visual things that catch their eye.

Auditory people

Learn more easily through their ears. Love listening to people teaching them things with voice, prefer lectures, audio or video to books. Remember exactly the words people use when talking to them, not so keen on images, graphs or remembering things from books. More easily distracted by sounds.

Kinaesthetic people

Learn through action, movement, touch. They prefer to see live demonstrations of skill, and to immediately practice the skill themselves. Remember physical things better, and anything where there is great emotion involved. More easily distracted by physical sensations, hot, cold, uncomfortableness, *etc.*

Auditory digital people

Learn best when everything is described in great detail and logically explained to them. Prefer to work things through in detail in their heads, very theoretical. Less hands on. Very hard to distract once they get into something.

Take the time to consider these different categories. Work out which one of the four you lean towards, and bear it in mind when you start learning. Most people are a mix of these different learning styles, with one predominant one. Don't expect that you'll be 100% visual or 100% auditory.

Once you have a good idea which one you are, match your style and you'll simply learn faster!

To become a speed-learner you should always be conscious of what helps you learn faster. Whether it's the environment, the teacher, the materials. The way the materials are delivered or how the teacher teaches you. Always be aware and focus more on the more effective learning situations and methods. Become a very aware and mindful learner. The best in the world are. Make sure you are too.

The next chapter will teach you how to order what you learn so that you reach the end goal faster.

Chapter Eleven: Learn in the Right Sequence

“If you have to eat two frogs, eat the ugliest one first.” — Brian Tracy

Once you have deconstructed what you are going to learn down to its most fundamental and essential components or building blocks. You should then have worked out which of those is more important – using the 20% to 80% principle.

The next most important thing to do is decide how to sequence these learning blocks. This is an even more powerful way to battle overwhelm.

If you learn Kendo, the Japanese martial art using a sword, then you must first focus on your footwork for weeks or months, before you hold a sword. Without this foundation you will be a danger to yourself and others.

If you are learning to write fiction, for another example, one of the first skills you should learn might be plot construction. If you start writing first, you can get lost.

Or if you follow all the steps in this book so far, you might have an end-goal to publish a novel. Then study novel-marketing first. Find out what is in demand. Then study digital self-publishing, so you have the confidence there will be demand for your novel and you will immediately be able to publish it.

Then you could find out the minimum length of the average novel in your genre, and then find the best mentors to teach you how to create a great novel.

Whatever it is you are trying to learn and accomplish, don't begin blindly with the first thing that comes to hand. Also, don't begin with what everyone else is doing first. Instead, spend some time working out the most intelligent sequence of components to learn in order to reach your learning goals in the quickest way possible.

The next chapter will give you a neat method to give you a complete understanding of a skill in one glance. So you can digest it all the faster.

Chapter Twelve: One-Page the Crucial Elements of Your Skill

“Our life is frittered away by detail. Simplify, simplify.” – Henry David Thoreau

This technique is short but powerful. We have been learning how to break down a skill to its most basic critical elements. And then breaking those down to the 20% that mean the most. Or the 20% that come first.

To further enhance the effects of this deconstruction to bite-sized chunks, see if you can encapsulate that 20% of the most critical components onto one sheet of paper.

This has a very visually empowering effect – if you can capture the entire essentials of a skill on one sheet of paper, and then stick it up on your wall to see in one glance all the most important components of the skill, it will suddenly become extremely accomplishable.

You can then even tick off the various components as you move through them, and master each step.

This might not always be possible, but try it. If you can do it, it's game-changing. You will feel very close to mastering the skill. Your morale and motivation will skyrocket and your heart will lift every time you glance at it on your wall.

In the next chapter, you will learn another crucial layer of how you learn faster, by fitting the skill into your life in the optimal way.

Chapter Thirteen: Plan Out Your Regular Learning Periods

“Most of us spend too much time on what is urgent and not enough time on what is important.” — Stephen R. Covey

Decide what kind of time frames will best fit your learning process. Plan them out in advance and put them into your diary as you would any important event.

This is important for your optimal progress as well. Decide and as you go along monitor and discover what your optimal frequency of learning is – twice a day? One whole afternoon, once a week? Two weeks of intensive learning, then three times a week after that?

Many people fail to learn quickly because they only set aside time to learn when their teacher tells them too. Or they tell themselves they will study when they have time. If you’re busy with other things, this spare time may never come.

Prioritise your learning periods, plan them out and commit to them.

As part of effective planning, ask if you can see any growing pains ahead. Plan in advance for them. You might out-reach a text book, outgrow a slower moving study partner, or even grow beyond a mentor. There’s no good in slowing and stalling at that point. Plan in advance what you will do and when the moment comes step smoothly into the new arrangement for your optimal progression.

In a class environment, very often the faster students get ahead. But then the pace of the class is slower because of the other students. Instead of making their own arrangements elsewhere the faster students usually stay, and slow their progress unnecessarily.

Do you need to study with someone else to get the most from it? If your learning style is auditory or kinaesthetic, this might help. You’ll need to plan this out too, as you have to coordinate with someone just as dedicated as you. They might become your accountability partner.

Morning or evening? When is your optimal time for progressing? Understand this and apply your 20/80 thinking to your planning to get the most progress

from your time. If you find you are learning 50% faster when you study first thing in the morning, then always study in the morning.

Whatever you uncover about your optimal learning times, plan them carefully into your diary or journal. And then hold to these planned times as fiercely as you would any other priorities in your life.

That is a key distinction master-learners make. They always value their learning and studying time as much as they value other things in their lives. Even though study-time rarely feels as urgent as the many other things. World-class learners focus on what is important, not just on what seems urgent in the moment. Or on what other people are telling them is urgent.

The next chapter reveals the most fundamental learning principle of both Bruce Lee and Arnold Schwarzenegger. One of the most important concepts in learning and mastering any skill or subject.

Chapter Fourteen: Reps & Sets, Reps & Sets

“Mastering any skill takes lots of reps and lots of sets.” – Arnold Schwarzenegger

"I fear not the man who has practices 10,000 kicks once. But I fear the man who has practiced one kick 10,000 times." – Bruce Lee

Arnold Schwarzenegger dominated the bodybuilding world through working harder and longer than anyone else. Continuous reps and sets, for hours a day, over years and years. He then took that approach to real estate investing, studying it continuously, every day, until he became a millionaire investor. Then he took it to acting, and fixing his accent for it. And then into politics, to master all the various skills that profession requires.

Everything you want to learn will benefit hugely from understanding this simple, overriding principle. You drill in a new skill with reps and sets. With repetition. Do the thing again and again and again, seeking to always improve every time. If you do a skill more times, and more diligently than the next person, you will progress faster. It's that simple.

Now, I know what you're thinking. This book is about how to learn faster, not how to slowly grind a skill out over a lifetime. Well that's true, and I'm sure you can see how much faster and more efficiently you will learn with the lessons we've covered so far.

The truth is mastery takes a combination of intelligent, strategic learning using the most sophisticated techniques and understandings of how the human mind works to speed it up. And also a committed, dedicated continuous ethic of hard work towards your goal.

We live in a get-results-quick age. Where everyone believes you can take shortcuts to results. The truth is you can get results quicker, but it will always take hard, grinding, repetitive work at some point, for some period of time.

Always. If you are not ready for that, and committed to doing it, then that hard moment will take you out when it arrives, just like it does most students.

On the other hand, some people are only willing to work hard, but not intelligently to learn and progress as fast as they can. These people will work hard for their whole lives, and never reach mastery.

It's the combination of the two mindsets that the world's greatest learners follow – intelligent, efficient learning technique and a hard work ethic.

You can repeat the skills many times, but if you're repeating the wrong things, you're wasting your time. If you're going to practice one kick 10,000 times, make sure it's the most important kick.

It's worth mentioning that Arnold Schwarzenegger not only did massive repetition when he was learning a skill. He also always went to find the best possible teacher, and begged them to teach him. He experimented and broke skills down, and followed most of the principles outlined in this book.

The next chapter is about the most powerful way to take notes, to double or triple their effectiveness in helping you to memorise and internalise new knowledge.

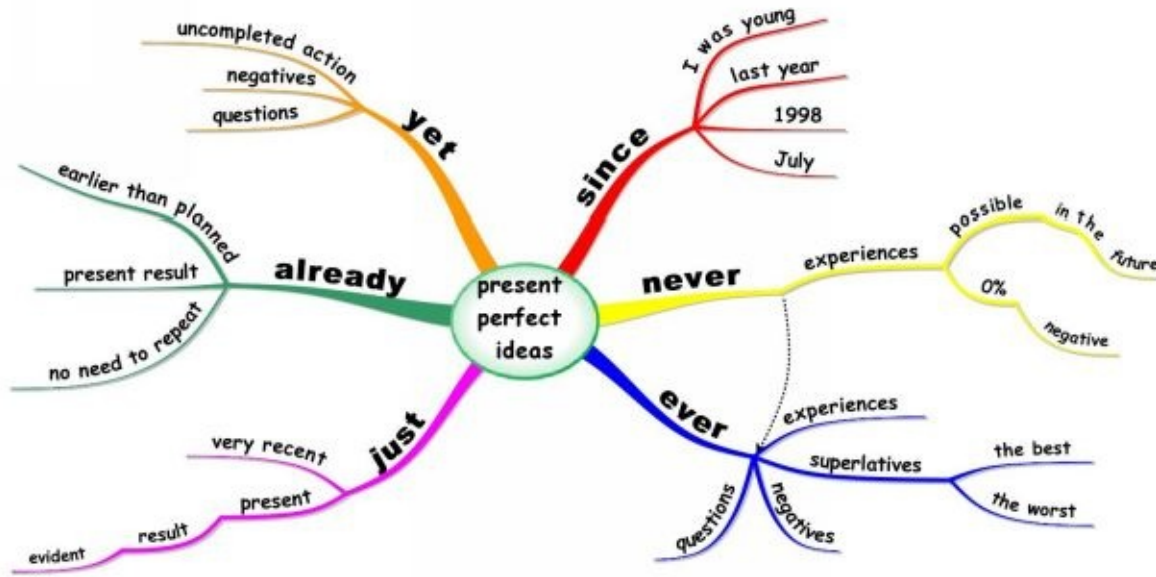
Chapter Fifteen: Take Notes in the Form of Colourful Mind Maps

“Mind maps are the meta language of the human race.” – Tony Buzan

If you’re going to take notes to help internalise your skill, then make sure you are using colours, and that you’re summarising your notes in mind maps.

Mind mapping is a very powerful method of laying out things we learn in a way that our brains can easily absorb in one glance. When we take notes the usual way, with dense rows of writing on white paper with a blue or black pen, our eyes glance at the page and it means nothing intuitively to our brains. Nothing is connected. We have to read all the lines and process each thing individually, working it out internally.

A mind map is a simple technique of storing notes that is scientifically proven to help our memories and understanding of complex topics. You write or draw the main topic or segment in the centre of a page, with a colourful circle around it. Then you draw flowing lines outwards like an octopus’s legs. And on those lines you write the sections of notes or ideas. Then to delve further into one of those ideas, you draw more legs flowing off from each one, with the lines never breaking.



What you have in the end is a very visual representation of the skill you are trying to learn. The benefits are that you can take one glance at that page and instantly your brain processes everything on it, and how they are all interconnected, prioritised, related, *etc.*

I recommend you look into mind mapping, and how to do it. Tony Buzan has some excellent books and resource on the topic.

The reason you should use colours beyond blue and black is that our brains simply respond very well to colour. It has an emotional impact and engages the attention and memory more strongly.

In the next chapter, you'll learn the most powerful learning concept taken from NLP. How to model a master to absorb his or her skill at incredible speed.

Chapter Sixteen: Your Secret Learning Weapon – NLP Modelling to Replicate a Master

“Success leaves clues. And people who produce outstanding results do specific things to create those results. If you precisely duplicate the actions of others, you can reproduce the same quality of results that they have.” – Tony Robbins

An exceptionally good technique to absorb the skills of an expert in a skill you want to learn is by modelling them. This effectively means breaking down one single element of a skill, breaking it down into tiny pieces, and then carefully replicating each tiny step. Even to the point of how they are breathing, what they are thinking and believing as they do it.

This advanced skill is something that NLP master practitioners study. But even for non-NLP practitioners, if you start to observe skilled people with anything near to this depth of attention you will certainly emulate them far more accurately. And as a result, you'll learn faster.

I'll illustrate with golf (modelling can be used for all skills, but for beginners it's far better to work with physical skills). If I find a master golfer, and I want to model his putting skills from near the hole (forgive my bad golfing terminology any avid golfers reading this!) I'll ask him to do the action a few times for me.

Then, by asking him to repeat it again and again, and by asking him, I'll work out how many smaller micro-stages that one action might take. And with these micro-stages, you can't go too small. One putt may be 6 or 7 stages.

The first stage might be him standing back from the ball and lining up with the hole using his eye. Then stepping forward, standing sideways over the ball and lining up again. Then taking a few practice swings and shuffling his feet a certain way. One last pause and line up. Then swinging through and putting. That's five micro-stages.

I would then study each of those micro-stages one by one in turn. So let's say the last stage – putting. I'd ask him to do it again, and again, and again. And I'd ask

him very detailed questions.

‘I notice your legs are about 1.5 feet apart, is that important?’

‘I notice the first two fingers of your right hand overlap your left hand, is that important?’

‘I notice you breathe twice, then you take a deeper breath, then you exhale as you swing, is that important?’

‘First you do this, then this, then this. Is that correct?’

And so on.

As you extract this detailed information, write it all down. Do not miss even the tiniest thing out. Even ask him what he thinks at every mini-stage of that one action – putting. Is his mind clear? Does he visualise anything? Does he hear anything in his mind? Does he say something to himself?

Write it all down.

I would then go through the same process for each of the 5 stages of putting. It might take 1 hour or two hours to get all this info. But trust me, it’s worth it.

Afterwards, I would ask him what his beliefs are around putting. He might tell me ‘I’m an excellent golfer’ ‘the ball always goes in’ ‘this is fun’ ‘calm, present, patient’, or anything at all. Let them tell you, never put words in someone’s mouth. There is no wrong answer.

Write those beliefs and self-talk down too.

Once you have finished, write all those minute details to each of the 5 stages down in the correct sequence. Write the beliefs at the beginning.

Now it is time for you to model it.

Take stage one, tell yourself you are going to believe those beliefs you wrote down just for the next hour. Then very, very slowly do every little bit *Exactly* as they did. Your feet are in the same place, you breathe in at that point, you look up there just in that way, you breathe out, you visualise what he visualises, you put your right fingers over your left like he did.

Modelling is *Exact* replication. Not vague copying. It is exact, perfect replication. Inside the mind, not only in the body. That is why you copy their exact posture and body movements and breathing. It’s very hard to stand and

breathe same way as someone without feeling and believing what they feel and believe.

Keep on doing it, again and again. Remember, reps and sets. Reps and sets. Until you are doing it automatically. You might have to repeat it 20 times or 50 times. Or 100 times. But keep on going.

And you will be amazed at the results you get. After just one day like this you can be doing that specific skill at a level it takes most students 6 months, 1 year or more to get to.

Just compare this for a moment to the usual method of copying someone. You ask them, they show you a few times. You try to do the same thing. They say, not quite like that, like this, they adjust a few things. You keep trying.

Following the normal way, it could take you months or years to get to the level you can get to in a couple of days from modelling a pro.

Just one important thing to remember – choose someone truly excellent to model. Remember chapter six! Only the best mentors, teachers and experts to learn from.

The next chapter will show you another incredibly valuable skill, which will supercharge the speed at which you absorb knowledge from books.

Chapter Seventeen: How to Read a Book in an Hour

“If I had one superpower, it would be to be the fastest reader in the world” –
quoted separately by Warren Buffett and Bill Gates

Most learning involves reading at some point. A manual, a book, a text book, lecture notes.

If you want to learn a skill, it might not be the fastest and most efficient way to reach your learning goals to read endless books about it. Perhaps you should just follow the best 3 books on the topic, and stick to other activities which give you greater return on time invested – better 20/80.

Also remember, many books out there are terrible in quality and misleading to learners. People give too much respect to books. Make sure you are more discerning. A great part of learning faster is learning from the right people, that means the best books too.

So before you follow the advice in this chapter first always work out your most valuable tasks, and your most valuable sequence of tasks too. If it's important and efficient for you to read, then read. If it's not, then don't.

Most of the time, if you want to master any topic or skill, it's generally those who read the most quality books on the topic who attain the highest level of knowledge. Reading is rarely a detrimental thing to do. But it can take up your valuable learning time.

So to save you time here is the fastest possible way to read a book, and take the value from it in under an hour. The key is to:

Look for golden nuggets

I have to make a distinction, this is not speed reading. As in the skill 'speed reading,' where you read sentences, paragraphs and pages at an incredibly fast rate. I think that is a worthy skill to develop. But it takes time and effort to learn how to do. More on that in the next chapter.

This method is almost as good and far more relaxing.

You'll be opening a book and aiming to take all the major lessons from that book and put them into your brain within the next hour. That is the goal. If we break that down you will see that this does not require reading every word in the book. You just want to find the golden nuggets. The key lessons and ideas of real value to you.

There is a misconception in the world that you have to read a whole book from front to back. Actually, you don't. Not at all. Follow these steps to learn all the most valuable lessons in a book in just one hour, without having to read the entire thing.

1. Prepare to work through the book three times
2. First time, about 5 – 10 minutes, read the front cover and back cover. Read the introduction and the conclusion. Also read the contents. Just read them all, nice and quickly.
3. Use a coloured pen or highlighter and highlight all the bits that interest you. All the golden nuggets of information.
4. Second time, take about 15 – 20 minutes. Read the first page of every chapter. Only the first page – if you see a story as the first thing, skip it, get to the meat. What are they saying?

Most books can say their major points and lessons in just 10 or 20 pages. But they have to make a 200-word book for the publishers to sell it. So they fill it up with stories and repetition. Just find the main point of the chapter as quickly as you can. So you are mostly skimming. Use that coloured pen a lot to highlight the good bits.

5. Third time, about 30-35 minutes. Skim through the whole book. Only read the first sentence of each paragraph. No more.
6. Stop reading!
7. Write up a few notes – the main lessons from that book. Use a mind map.

There. In an hour you have just mined the gold from that book. And I guarantee you that if someone else spends a week reading that same book word by word, at the end of it they will not be able to tell you much more about the lessons in that book than you!

It's a magical and liberating experience first time you read a book this way. The fantastic thing about it is that you can read a book like this if you like every day

if you like. Imagine how quickly you will progress in knowledge about a certain skill at that rate.

If a book a day, or a book in an hour seems too much to begin, just start with one book every three days, and increase in speed over time.

Now I said this method replaces speed reading. But there is nothing wrong with teaching yourself to read 2 or 3 times faster than you currently do at the same time. The next chapter gives you the simplest and quickest route to achieve this in the world.

Chapter Eighteen: Speed Reading Made Easy

“I am not a speed reader. I am a speed understander.” – Isaac Asimov

Now, I really do recommend you learn to skim and goldmine books for info, just as described in the previous chapter. But if you are going to read anything, you may as well do it really, really fast. Which will speed up all your learning.

This chapter will teach you a technique to train yourself to speed read 300% faster, by the end of the week. This method is directly from Tim Ferriss. And it works really well. Do the following exercise every day for a week, and see the massive difference in your reading speed.

Step one is to determine your current reading speed. Take a book you want to read. Lay it out flat on the table. Count the number of words in an average line. So count it for 5 lines and divide it by five. Make a note of this number.

Now, set a timer for one minute. And begin reading. Read normally, as you would now, try to comprehend everything. When the timer beeps, work out how many words you read and make a note of it. That's your baseline.

Next, you will begin reading with your ultimate reading tool. A pen. With the cap on. The human mind reads better and more confidently with a guider. The pen will guide and track your eyes, also setting the pace as you start to get faster.

For the next step, we will focus on speeding you up. To create this new habit. So don't worry at all about comprehension. Set the timer again to 2 minutes. And move the pen along each line quickly. One second on each line, no slower. Never backtrack, keep going. Follow just above the pen tip with your eyes and read. But don't worry at all about comprehension.

Take a break after that 2 minutes, for just a few seconds. Set the timer again to 3 minutes.

Now, do exactly as the previous step. But this time half a second on each line. No more! You are racing along. Do not worry at all about comprehension. Just keep going, that fast. And do not backtrack.

The next exercises is to train you to start trusting your peripheral vision. There is no actual need for us to read to the far side of each line on each page – the couple of words right next to the edge of the page. Using automatic peripheral vision, our minds can quite easily read 3 or 4 words out to the right or left of the word we are looking at.

But we need to un-train old habits that tell us to look directly at every single word.

First, set the timer for one minute. Now read at a pace of one line per second, but begin one word in from the margin on each line and finish one word in from the opposite margin. Read like this for one minute. Using the pen as a tracker. Again, don't worry about comprehension.

When the timer beeps, set it to 2 minutes. Now read again, using the pen to track at a steady speed of one second per line. This time start and stop 2 words from the edge of the page on both sides.

And lastly, set the timer for 3 minutes. Read at a very fast pace of half a second per line – keep this pace up with your tracking pen. And this time start each line 3 words from the left margin, and finish each line 3 words from the right margin. Forget about comprehension, it's fine if you can't even comprehend anything. Just keep it up for 3 whole minutes until the timer beeps.

When it beeps, stop!

Now, immediately set the timer to one minute again. And this time read at your fastest comprehension rate. Really try to understand everything, just like when you read normally. You're finding out your new reading speed. And you'll probably find it's at least 200% if not 300% faster!

We've covered the foundational strategies to speed-learning. And you've also learned many of the most powerful techniques for learning skills and absorbing knowledge ever developed.

The last section of the book looks into a critical component of learning – your memory. With 6 extremely powerful life-changing memory techniques that could certainly help you learn 5 or 10 times faster than you ever have before.

Section Three: The Memory Techniques of World Memory Champions

Chapter Nineteen: How to Permanently Memorize Anything

“Your memory works with images and journeys. The more vivid and interesting these images are, the better.” – Dominic O’Brien, 8-time World Memory Champion

One of the greatest skills you can master to help you learn quickly and permanently is the skill of memory. This is a skill easier to master quickly than you might imagine. And it can be an incredible boost to your learning speed.

With the following memory techniques and a little practice you will be able to instantly memorize and permanently recall names and facts, for any subject you study, or any sequence of actions, key lessons, new words in any language, speeches, presentations, and numbers. All to an incredible level of accuracy.

Sounds too good to be true? Try these techniques out as soon as you learn them. And prepare to be amazed.

Before we begin, think about how your wonderful learning brain evolved. Over hundreds of thousands, even millions of years, it evolved in the African Savannah, where all human ancestors first came from. Out there in the wilderness, the only information you ever needed was physical. Things of sight, sound, smell, taste.

You remembered journeys, locations, landmarks. Plants, animals, tracks and signs. That is what the human mind evolved to remember and to memorize. Numbers are new, most abstract ideas of knowledge are new, even people’s names are quite new. Back then you would only know 100 people your whole life.

As a result of this evolution, your mind and its powers of memorizing and recall all work with imagery, and journeys. We are just starting to understand this. Right now, think of the home you lived in as a child – now in your mind’s eye walk through that home. Go into every room. Now, go outside and walk down the street to the nearest sweet shop (every child remembers that journey!)

See how easy it was? And you may not have thought of your childhood home in that kind of detail in years. But it quickly came accurately to your mind. And it's not only physical places and journeys we're familiar with that we remember permanently. Think of the best holiday you ever went on.

Where did you stay? In hotel, camping site, house? Go there right now. And walk along a little journey around the inside of your holiday home, then from your holiday home go to a nearby place you remember. Notice the little landmarks along the way – perhaps the porch, then the driveway, then the big tree on the corner, the painted wall of the first home you walk past.

See how easily it comes to mind? And it's rather pleasant too, isn't it.

That is the awesome power of your memory right there. The simple trick to mastering your memory, used by memory world champions like Dominic O'Brien who could memorize the order of every card piled up from 50 decks of cards, and recall them instantly too.

The simple trick is to use your natural ability to remember visual, physical journeys quite clearly. That is key to remembering anything. This chapter and the following will show you how you can use this to greatly speed up your progress in any skill at all.

First, let's do a little exercise just as an introduction. To illustrate the process, please carry out this exercise. Take a look at the following shopping list of items:

1. Tomato sauce
2. Sausages
3. Apricots
4. Milk
5. Gravy
6. Chocolate bar
7. Chicken fillets
8. Dog food
9. Broccoli
10. Pasta

Now, close your eyes and recall the list in the correct order from number one.

How was it; easy or hard? Probably a bit tricky. But in a couple of minutes you will not only remember it perfectly, you'll remember this list permanently. If you choose to. Forwards and backwards.

To begin, think of your home. In your mind's eye quickly walk through your home, start in a place at the top – perhaps your bedroom. Then walk through on a route that takes you past every room, or into every room of the house. You can lead out into the garden or onto the driveway at the end.

Go back over this route and walk through it again. Make sure you have at least 10 steps on that journey.

So the first step could be your bedroom, the second step the corridor outside your bedroom, the third step the upstairs bathroom, then the fourth step the next bedroom, then the stairs leading down, and so on.

Got all 10 steps? Great.

Next look again at the shopping list.

The first item on the list is 'tomato sauce'. In your mind go to step one, perhaps it's your bedroom. Now imagine the entire bedroom is covered in tomato sauce. You're drowning in it! Imagine the mess, the smell, imagine it squelching between your toes.

Now go to step two in your route. Perhaps it's the corridor outside your bedroom. The second item on the list is a sausage. Picture in step two a *Giant* sausage filling the corridor! You have to climb over it, but it's really hot! Hear the sizzle of cooking sausage, the smell filling the air.

Now go through every step of the journey, and put all the items on the list into each step.

The key to making these images memorable is to make them as big and ridiculous as possible! That is what your mind remembers best. Make them strange, you can have flying, talking apricots if you like. Add in smell, touch, taste, sound. The more senses you can use the better for your memory.

And our minds also remember any hilarious or violent or sexual images the easiest too. So really have fun with it. Don't worry, no one else will ever see the images you choose.

Once you've made it through all the steps. You've done it.

Now, I'll ask you again. Close your eyes and tell me the list, one to ten. Simply go into your home in your mind's eye and go to step one – your bedroom. And remember item number one. Then walk along your route, and at each step let the vivid image there remind you of the item.

Did you remember all ten items? I bet you did.

That technique is the basis of having a masterful memory. The amazing thing is there is no limit to it. You could make that route 100 steps long and remember 100 items. Or 1,000 items, or more.

In the next chapters you'll learn how to use this powerful visualisation trick to remember all kinds of things and greatly speed up your learning speed in anything. Starting in the next chapter with how to permanently remember the most important lessons and facts of a skill.

Chapter Twenty: Remember Any Number of Facts for Quick Recall

“Memory... is the diary that we all carry about with us.” – Oscar Wilde

Every skill and new learning endeavour requires remembering new facts, pieces of information, lessons and bits of advice you picked up here and there.

You can use the journey-memory method from the previous chapter to memorise the most important lessons. So every time you are studying and you learn something you have to remember, you can create a strong visual image in your mind, just like in the previous chapter for the shopping list.

You can create any image at all which reminds you of that lesson or fact. Make it as big and colourful and crazy as possible, using as many senses as possible. Just so that if you see that image again you will immediately be reminded of what the lesson or fact is. Then like before, store that fact or lesson at some point along a journey.

All you need to do is prepare the journey pathway in your mind. If you intend to do this a lot for one skill, then perhaps you might like to use an area which you associate with that skill. For example, if the skill is tennis, you might like to create paths all around where you play tennis. One path could be around your favourite tennis courts. Another path could be through the sports centre. Another one around the sports centre, another path leading up to it. Each path 10 or 15 or 20 steps long.

If you are memorising facts for history at school, why not make all the paths around your school. Or around an awesome historical place you once visited and enjoyed.

Now, write down the sequence as steps. And one by one walk through your route and put the lessons in there. Just find an image or two that reminds you of it, blow it up and make it crazy, vivid, hilarious, loud, smelly, violent or sexual. And add in touch too, what can you feel? Remember, all these things make an image memorable.

Carry on with every step and every lesson. And then run through it once to check you've got it all. There you have it! Those lessons will stay there unless you replace them. Walk through them any time you feel like it to quickly remind yourself of them, or drum them in deeper.

These facts could be either in your new area of learning as a whole, or for one small section of the subject. You could even combine this skill with NLP modelling, where you recorded the intimate details of a single stage of the skill.

Next chapter, we'll look at how to expand this visualisation skill to build an entire memory palace.

Chapter Twenty One: Building Your Very Own Memory Palace

“One trick, known as the journey method or ‘memory palace,’ is to conjure up a familiar space in the mind's eye, and then populate it with images of whatever it is you want to remember.” – Joshua Foer

You may have heard about the mysterious power of memory palaces. Top memory champions and ‘mind magicians’ like Derren Brown make memory palaces seem mysterious and incredible and difficult to master.

In fact, if you carried out the exercise in the last two chapters, you have already begun to build your own memory palace! It really is quite simple. Nothing in this book is so complicated that you cannot go and take it and use it right now to start learning faster.

To store lots of info quickly using a memory palace, you just need an area of the town or city you know well. It doesn’t have to be a town or city, it could be a village or somewhere in the country. It’s just that urban places have so much detail and so many paths, roads, buildings, *etc.* And all these little twists and turns and landmarks make it very easy to create journeys with many easily distinguishable steps.

But really, all you need is a place you know well that you can walk around in your mind’s eye.

Then, when you have chosen your area, you choose your subject. And you begin to memorize facts, walking along the paths of your ‘palace’. Just create visual imagery for every fact, name, place, lesson you like and keep on going. Keep on expanding.

Remember that in your mind it is fine to link up imaginary places that are not linked in real life. For example you might have a path that leads up to your bedroom. Then you could climb out of your bedroom window into the National Gallery in London or onto a street you know in Paris or New York. You can create your palace any way you like, it’s only a good idea to leave a little visual

reminder of the link. I might leave a French baguette leaning up against the window in my bedroom to remind myself that it leads to Paris.

You can isolate certain areas of your palace for certain topics. For example, Derren Brown used Soho in London to memorise history of art. When I was learning Spanish I used one side of the river in Valencia for the male words, the other side for the female words.

"You take buildings or locations that you know. And you condense things you want to remember into memorable and bizarre objects and you place them into this building that you know inside your mind. I have a very large version of it, so I use central London as map rather than a particular building. I am basically memorizing the story of art chronologically. I plot objects on streets and buildings in London." – Derren Brown

This wonderful skill is both fun to do and life-changing to master. And it certainly greatly speeds up the learning of any skill or subject under the sun.

In fact, you can even use it to learn languages ten times faster, as you will see in the next chapter.

Chapter Twenty Two: How to Instantly Memorise Vocabulary in Any Language

"To have another language is to possess a second soul." – Charlemagne

You can use these visualisation techniques to make it a hundred times easier to memorise new words in any language. Once again, you will be using journeys and vivid visualisation, and you'll have a huge advantage over anyone else trying to memorise new words the old way, using simple repetition.

Firstly, if you are learning a new language you need quite a lot of space in your mind, a lot of journeys and locations to store images in. So think of a town or city you can dedicate to this language in your mind. As I mentioned in the last chapter, I used Valencia in Spain to store my Spanish vocabulary.

As I did with Valencia, a good trick is to divide your chosen city up into male and female sections, and perhaps neuter too. Many languages have male and female and neuter nouns. This will make it easier to remember which is which, but it's not entirely necessary.

When you learn a new word, put it somewhere in your language city that makes sense. For example, let's say we're learning French. And my new word is shoe, which in French is 'chaussure'.

In my mind, I would go to a shoe shop I know in my city. There I would put an image in the window, or perhaps somewhere inside, which reminds me of the sound 'chaussure'. This will be different for everyone, but what jumped into my mind after a few seconds thinking was 'Short Sir' which sounds similar. So I will imagine a very short man wearing a suit and looking quite official, like someone you might call 'sir' and he's trying on a very large shoe, and the assistant is saying 'You are too *short sir!*'

Or something like that.

I know 'Short Sir' is not exactly the same sound as 'chaussure' but it is close enough to serve as a hook to my memory, and bring the word to mind when I see that image. Try it, you will find a link like this is all you need. And when you get

into the practice of creating these images, it only takes 5 or 10 seconds to come up with one.

If you try to get the exact sound every time you will find it very hard indeed, and it's not necessary. A similar-sounding hook to help my memory is good enough. I imagine the word is deep in my brain somewhere. This image is like a bridge, leading me straight to that word. Or the image is like a hook, which draws the real word out so I can use it.

When I am speaking French later on and I want to remember the word for shoe, that image of the very short man trying on a big shoe in the shoe shop will leap to my mind. And I will remember 'chaussure' and say it. Every time I say the word, it will stay more permanently in my surface memory and eventually I won't need the memory hook any more. The word will be automatic. But the image and the memory hook will always be there. Just in case.

In that one shoe shop I could store all the French words related to shoes, socks, *etc.* In a nearby bakery I'll store all my words relating to bread and baked food. In the sports centre I'll store all my words relating to sports. And so on.

In this same way you can build your language memory palace and start learning languages ten times faster. Try it out today. It's effective, and it's fun!

In the next chapter, you will learn the power of visualisations to always remember people's names. A very useful skill for skill acquisition and life in general.

Chapter Twenty Three: Memorising Names Easily and Permanently

“The sweetest and most important sound in any language to any person, is the sound of their own name.” – Dale Carnegie

This skill is very useful for life, and for learning. If you have any academic subject that requires quick and permanent memory of significant individuals in your field or the history of your field, then this skill is for you.

If you are learning any skill and want to know all about it and all the places and people related to it, it's for you too. In fact, as we spoke about earlier, one of the key techniques to advancing rapidly in a skill is finding the right people to learn from and study with. And one of the key skills in human relations is remembering names, so if you can remember the names of everyone you meet you are far more likely to get ahead in any learning endeavour.

There are a few ways to use this visualisation skill from the previous chapters to remember names better. I'll teach you the quick and easy method first, which will work 80% of the time. And then the more accurate and developed method later.

Basically, when you meet someone, repeat their name a few times (always good practice anyway). Then right there while you are talking to them, or perhaps just after you've finished the conversation and moved on, make a vivid picture connected to their face and body. This picture instantly recalls their name to you.

For example, if their name is Matt. You can imagine a giant beer mat balancing on his head. He is wobbling about under the weight of it. If the name is Anne, you could imagine a swarm of 'ants' climbing over her – you'll always remember unpleasant images like that. But perhaps you'd rather use a nicer image, so you could picture her carrying lots of cute 'animals' or offering you a big bowl of Italian 'antipasti,' or whatever word jumps to your mind that has an 'Anne' sound to it.

Once you've done this, and you have enhanced the image in any way you can

using the tips from the last two chapters, you can relax. You might not meet her again for weeks or months, but you will usually remember the image and her name when you see her.

If you are really serious about developing a perfect name-memory, a good exercise when you get home later is to go over these images in your mind. Strengthen them and make them more vivid and strange – more memorable. This way you are even more likely to remember someone's name when they bump into you somewhere a few months later. And won't they be impressed when you quickly recall their name!

Of course, you can use this technique for any names you learn as part of your skill or subject of study. It works exactly the same way if you can see a picture of the person. But if there is only a name and no picture, connect the sound of the person's name to the thing they are famous for, and it will stay in your mind later on. This is a terrific ability for history students preparing for exams.

Another quick and easy trick for visualisation with names is if someone you meet has the same name as a friend of yours, or a famous person. Here you can quickly picture them together. Perhaps hugging or hi 5-ing. So if you meet a Matt and you already have a friend called Matt, quickly picture the two of them shaking hands, or just standing next to each other.

Dominic O'Brien developed a more sophisticated method of remembering names permanently. It takes a little getting used to, but it's worth the effort. And you can use this method to memorise first name *and* surname. A very impressive skill for most people who don't know about these memory tricks and techniques.

To make your memorisation and recall closer to 100% accurate, you need a location in the image too. As you meet someone, pay attention to your first impressions of them when you look at their face. Really go with the first thing you feel. You can always find something.

Perhaps they remind you a bit of a famous person like Oprah Winfrey or Tony Robbins. Perhaps they look a bit like an elf to you, or a bit ratty. Or they remind you of a gladiator, or an accountant.

Don't worry if your impression is not complimentary. They'll never know about it! Just go with your first impression.

Now from that first impression, quickly think of a location that goes well with it. So Oprah Winfrey would be sitting on her couch in her TV studio. If they look

like an elf it might be a leafy forest glade. Or if they remind you of an accountant, then an accountant's office, big piles of invoices everywhere.

Next, put the person you just met smack bang in the middle of that location. And then use your imagery skills to find physical things that remind you of both their names. So if their name is John Robinson, you might think of your other friend John (or perhaps him sitting on the john – as in the toilet) and for the surname you might think of a Robin (the bird) or Batman's sidekick Robin.

So if I met someone called John Robinson who looks a bit like Bill Murray, my location would be the Ghost Busters headquarters. I'd picture him there sitting on the john with a giant robin pecking him, trying to pick him up and fly away with him. He's shouting and trying to fight the robin off. Making lots of noise.

Pretty strange image, right? But now every time I meet John, I'll quickly recall that image and in half a second tell him his full name – John Robinson. Think he'll be impressed?

And this process works wonders when remembering historical or important names for the topic or skill you are learning. When you're studying you have much more time to create these images at your leisure.

Of course, this process with the location is a little longer than the first one. So to begin with you might prefer to do it after you've finished talking with them, perhaps even at home later on. After a little practice you will be doing visualisations like this in a few seconds so you can easily do it during conversations.

And always remember to enhance the imagery as much as you can!

Next, one of the most valuable uses of this memory method. You will be able to use your new memory skills to remember an entire speech or presentation easily, so you can remain calm and confident in any public speaking situation. And never have to use notes or flashcards again.

Chapter Twenty Four: Never Need Notes Again for a Speech or Presentation

“It usually takes me more than three weeks to prepare a good impromptu speech.” – Mark Twain

Would you like to be one of those speakers who just gets up on stage and delivers the entire thing without once glancing at any notes?

People who speak like that seem so genuine, powerful and present. So connected to the audience. It instantly makes the presentation ten times better – no podium or fumbling with notes.

Perhaps you need this skill as part of your academic studies or some other thing you’re learning that requires presenting as part of the testing procedure.

Memory journeys like the ones you have been creating are 100% reliable. Especially if you run over them a few times in your mind beforehand. Don’t take my word for it, test them lots yourself, until you see it’s true.

This skill will change the way you present forever.

To begin, simply write down your excellent speech or presentation. Break it up into reasonable sections. For each section create one image that sums up that whole point. And then choose a nice path to walk down – give it as many steps as it needs to fit in the whole presentation.

Then of course, the next step is to stroll along your journey, taking each part of the speech in turn and putting the image into the step on the path. As always, make it as vivid and memorable as possible.

Then finally, the fun part. Give a test presentation. All the way through. And prepare to be delighted, it’s amazing. You don’t need any notes no matter how long the presentation is. You won’t lose your place once. Try it today and find out!

Memorising speeches using these techniques is in many ways more reliable than notes. Notes you can get lost with, you might drop them, or glance down and

forget what something means.

On a journey in your mind you can easily stroll down the path, see the reminder, plunge enthusiastically into that part of your speech. Continue on down the path, see the next reminder, move on. All while never breaking eye contact with your audience. They just see you standing or moving gracefully on the stage. Hands at your sides, talking directly to them.

If someone interrupts you with a question, you can remember where you were in the path, and casually, confidently go and talk about what they want for a bit. Then in your mind you unerringly return to exactly the place on the path you left off. The location reminds you of where you were, and you calmly continue to the next point.

In the next chapter, you'll learn how to use this powerful memory skill to remember even numbers permanently.

Chapter Twenty Five: How to Remember Number, Permanently

“You don't have to be a mathematician to have a feel for numbers.” – John Forbes Nash, Jr.

It may well be that as part of your learning you have to remember lots of numbers. Perhaps dates of events, if you are studying something academic. Or perhaps the number of moves in a sequence if you are studying martial arts or chess. Perhaps you're learning poker, and want to remember the number of each card previously played.

Numbers are a big part of our lives, but they completely lack any visual character. The key to memorizing numbers is to give them this visual character.

Like we spoke about in the first chapter of this memory section of the book, our brains evolved over the millennia to remember physical, visual things – routes, plants, animals. Not little black squiggles on paper that represent a number. And certainly not dozens of them all side by side.

Those mean nothing to the deep, primal part of our brain. The part that works in colours and sounds, emotions and images. The part that remembers things.

However, by using your understanding of the visual nature of your own brain, you can translate numbers into images, and easily remember as many as you like using memory paths, just like in the previous chapters.

There are two ways to do this. The simple way, and the masterful way.

Firstly, the simple way. Just take the numbers 0 to 10.

For each one, pick an object or person that rhymes with that number. So for me zero is 'Hiro' a character I know from the TV show 'Hero'. One is gun. Two is a zoo. Three is a tree. And so on. No need to be clever or complicated.

Now you have a visual representation for each number, you can easily put these numbers on a memory journey – a memory path. If I have to remember my new

PIN is 3120, for example. I can create a quick journey at my local bank. The four steps are; outside the entrance to the bank, then just inside the doors, then in the queue to the bank teller, and then at the bank teller.

Step one is 3 = tree. So I put a giant tree blocking the way into the bank. Next it's 1 = gun. So I could imagine a bank robber at step two, just inside the bank door waving around a huge gun. Then it's 2 = zoo. So I'll picture the unusual sight of lots of zoo animals queueing up inside, smelly and noisy. And then 0 = Hiro. So I imagine the character Hiro sitting behind the bank teller glass, trying to serve a giraffe.

Now, I will always remember that number, even 6 months later. Especially if I revisit it every now and then, which I will automatically do when I go to an ATM to withdraw money.

That's the simplistic way to remember a sequence of numbers, and it's definitely worth using for simple numbers.

There is a far more advanced and powerful method.

The second method was also devised by the memory genius Dominic O'Brien. It takes a little time to set up, but once you have it, it will change your life, guaranteed. Numbers will always be effortless from now on. No matter how long and complex they are.

To turn numbers into visual representations, we're going to create an army of helpers. Firstly, you need to write down a list of pairs of numbers all the way from 00 to 99.

So write down 00, 01, 02, 03, and so on. Write them down the side of your page, so you can write something next to each number. Or type them into an excel spreadsheet.

Next, we are going to correlate a letter to each number 0 to 9.

0 = O

1 = A

2 = B

3 = C

4 = D

5 = E

6 = S

7 = G

8 = H

9 = N

This is the only bit of old fashioned memorising you have to do. Memorise these number-letter correlations. They are pretty easy, and once you begin the next exercise they will get drummed in deep.

The next step will be creating a character for each pair of numbers. Choose a celebrity you know, or anyone from history. Or a movie character, a character from a book or a cartoon. Anyone you like.

Make each character doing a very specific action. So for 00 you might have Olive Oil (Popeye's girl) and her action is eating spinach.

For 30 you might have Conan O'Brien (3 = C, 0 = O). Action, sitting behind a table asking questions.

For 74 you could have Gerard Depardieu (7 = G, 4 = D). Action, waving a sword.

And so on. You can find lists online to help you with this. But it's far better for your memory if you come up with people yourself. Characters you know and love. However, I know the first half of the numbers are easy to come up with. Then towards the end it can become really tricky. So just come up with anyone you can. You will remember them through sheer repetition.

Then, take time to memorise your characters. If you know the number – letter correlation, you will find it easy to recall each one after a little time. For example, to remember 30, you'll think, 'ok, 3 = C and 0 = O. Whose name begins with C O? Aha! Conan O'Brien.'

They will come to you faster and faster the more you do it. Until Conan O'Brien becomes completely and permanently linked to the number 30 in your mind forever.

With this brilliant system you can remember a 4-digit number with just one character on your memory journey! You do this by combining the character of the first two numbers with the action of the character of the second two numbers.

So if my number to remember was 7430, I would immediately make an image of Gerard Depardieu sitting behind a talk show desk asking questions. That image would stick!

The moment I saw the image later on, I would see Gerard Depardieu doing Conan O'Brien's action. I would remember that means $74 + 30$. 7430.

Imagine how powerful this is. You can prepare a memory journey of just 25 steps, and use it to permanently memorize a 100-digit number, ready to tell anyone you like. As a first exercise with this skill I recommend memorising PI to 100 digits then going and showing it off.

And then every time you learn any new skill or subject and numbers are involved, you will have a powerful tool to instantly store them in your mind.

Phone numbers take just 2 and a half steps. Pin numbers or dates take just one step. The possibilities are endless. Take the time to develop this system, you won't regret it!

Conclusion: How to Implement these Techniques to Start Learning 300% Faster Today

"The way to get started is to quit talking and begin doing." – Walt Disney

There you have it. You now have 25 of the most powerful speed-learning techniques ever developed at your fingertips. Make sure you start implementing them today.

It's best to begin with the techniques that interested you the most. Choose whichever ones got you the most excited. And certainly work to implement the overall principles, mindsets and strategies from the first section. These will take some thinking over and developing, but with deep and life-changing results.

Watch out for what other people say about learning. Learning fast is a science, and most people do not understand what their brains are capable of. You can show them best, not with words, but with action. By inspiring them with how much you achieve following these principles. Show them how much you can truly learn in a very short amount of time.

Hopefully, one day these techniques will be part of mainstream education. But until that day, you have a huge unfair advantage over the competition. Enjoy!

And thank you for reading.

"The greatest crime in the world is not developing your potential. When you do what you do best, you are helping not only yourself, but the world." – Roger Williams